center at Meiktila, while XXXIII Corps continued to advance toward Mandalay. By February 1945, the XXXIII Corps had seized control of the crossings over the Ayeyarwaddy near Mandalay. In late February, the 7th Indian Division captured the crossing at Nyaung-U near Pakokku. The 17th Indian Division and the 255th Indian Armored Brigade then attacked the Japanese garrison at Meiktila. The Japanese tried to relieve their garrison and, after failing, tried to recapture the town itself. After suffering heavy casualties and losing most of their artillery pieces Meiktila eventually fell on March 1, 1945. Following the loss of Meiktila the Japanese retreated further south to Pyawbwe.

Following their success in Upper Burma, the XXXIII Corp launched a dual-pronged assault down the Ayeyarwaddy River valley against the Japanese 28th Army. The IV Corp led the main assault on the “railway valley” followed by the Sittang River. The IV Corp were held by remnants of the Japanese 33rd Army at Pyawbwe until a flanking move by the Allies caught the Japanese by surprise and broke their defensive lines. From this point, the Allied advance to Rangoon faced little organized opposition from the Japanese. An uprising by Karen guerillas prevented the reconstituted Japanese 15th Army reaching Toungoo before the IV Corp captured it. The Japanese 105th Independent Mixed Brigade made a last stand 40 miles north of Rangoon on April 25, 1945, and held out April 30, 1945, allowing for the evacuation of Rangoon. On May 1, 1945, a Gurkha battalion cleared the Japanese rearguard from the mouth of the Rangoon River and Rangoon was liberated on May 22, 1945.

Following the fall of Rangoon the Japanese put up scattered resistance. In Arakan the Japanese 28th Army had retreated to the Pegu Yomas, where they hoped to break out and join the BAA. Miscommunication between the Japanese 28th Army and the 33rd Army led to the 33rd mounting their attack two weeks before the 28th Army was ready to break out. The break out was a failure. In all, the Japanese lost nearly 10,000 men. This effectively was the last campaign in the Burma theatre. Japanese forces in Burma surrendered on September 13, 1945.